

SURREY SCOUT



MAY, 1980

No. 395

County Commissioner

Readers of "Surrey Scout" who, as I continually urge, should also read the national magazine "Scouting", will have noted with great pleasure that our Field Commissioner, Peter Lankester, has been awarded the Silver Wolf "in recognition of services of the most exceptional character to Headquarters over many years". This award, the announcement of which was released only after the April edition of "Surrey Scout" had gone to press, is the unrestricted gift of the Chief Scout and there is no doubt that everyone in Surrey will agree that it was certainly most well deserved.

Peter has been Field Commissioner for Surrey for over 11 years and we share him with Kent, East and West Sussex. He is well known around the County and many District Commissioners and Scouters have a good cause to be grateful to Peter for his help and advice on how to tackle a wide range of problems. I am sure that you will all join me in sending him our warmest congratulations.

John Havers has been Assistant County Commissioner (International) since 1965 and feels that after so many years in this appointment the time has come for a change. With some reluctance I have accepted his resignation and should like to place on record my own warm appreciation for his unstinting efforts over the past 15 years in promoting the international aspects of Scouting. This has not only included giving advice and counsel to those travelling or taking parties abroad - as well as advice on when not to do so! - but also ensuring that visiting parties of Scouts from overseas are given a warm welcome and hospitality in the County.

To succeed John Havers I am very pleased to announce that Terry Maggs, who until recently was Assistant District Commissioner (Venture Scouts) for

Epsom and Ewell, has accepted my invitation to become A.C.C. (International) with effect from 1st April, 1980.

In addition to leading the 1979 County Jamboree Contingent to Canada, Terry has travelled widely abroad on Scouting and family trips. I am sure that he will bring a fresh approach to this very important aspect of Scouting and will help all members of the Movement in Surrey to appreciate their membership of a truly worldwide brotherhood. We wish him every success in this new appointment.

The County Swimming Gala will be held on Saturday, 1st November at Guildford. Staines District have again kindly undertaken the organisation of this important annual event and I hope that this year it will receive one hundred per cent support from all Districts. Swimming galas at County and District levels all help to focus attention on this activity which is not only a sport in which everyone can join, but is also one which is a real life saver - not least for the individual concerned.

Every year the national and local press contain sad details of fatalities in water which would not have occurred if those involved had learned to swim. It is taught more widely in schools these days but we should also do everything we can in Scouting to encourage swimming. In some areas where the facilities are poor this may involve quite an effort to gain access to suitable baths but, wherever and whenever possible, facilities should be made available for our younger members to gain their swimmers' badges and then to go on to gain qualifications in life-saving. This is just one way, but a most important one, in which Scouting can really serve the community.

GORDON BATES

Scouts

Congratulations to Don Ammon and his Patrol from 1st Ashford Common Troop, Sunbury & Sheperton District, who won this year's County First Aid Competition. Sixteen teams entered from nine Districts and a high standard was achieved in this important field of Scout training. The correct type of training in First Aid is of paramount importance and this is why we value the help and interest of other agencies who are expert in the subject. Our thanks on this occasion go to the St. John's Ambulance Brigade who judged the competition, and to Surrey Heath District who made all the arrangements and were our hosts.

I am pleased that this contribution to "Surrey Scout" should start by referring to the success of a Patrol as it prompts me to dwell upon that fundamental concept in the running of a Scout Troop - the Patrol System. So often I fear we only give lip service to its importance. It is not just a convenient way of running games and collecting subscriptions - there is much more to it than that. Rather than comment for a few paragraphs on the subject as I have done in the past, I should like to use a different presentation by taking the individual letters of the two words PATROL SYSTEM and 'pausing for thought' after each letter. These are just some of my own ideas - please try the exercise for yourself - I am sure you can improve on some of my own initial thoughts.

- P** for Patrol Leader. The key person in the Troop to make the Patrol System work. A member of the Patrol Leaders' Council, playing a major role in planning Troop programmes and in carrying out the plans.
- A** for Activity. A Scout looks for fun, adventure and activity. The implementation of the Patrol System should provide an abundance of these three component parts in every Patrol and Troop event.
- T** for Training. We operate a progressive training scheme and the best way of ensuring that this happens is to involve the Patrol Leader and Patrol, ensuring that the needs of each Scout are reviewed and catered for regularly.
- R** for Responsibility. We as Leaders have a clear responsibility to support our Patrol Leaders as

they establish and develop their skills in running their Patrols.

- O** for Outdoors. Scouting should be operating in the outdoors as often as possible. There are unique opportunities for the Patrol System in so many activities which can only be mounted effectively away from the Headquarters.
- L** for Law & Promise. Let us not forget the fundamental importance of ensuring that Patrols operate at all times through our Law & Promise - or put another way, the "Scout Spirit" should always be in evidence.
- S** for Summer Camp. The culmination for any Troop each year when the Patrol really comes into its own. The camp should be run along Patrol lines with the Patrol Leaders' Council playing a key role at all stages.
- Y** for Youth Service. Yes, Scouting is part of the Youth Service, and the training for citizenship we give in the 11 - 16 year age range, through operating the Patrol System, is vitally important to each boy.
- S** for Service. Patrols should be encouraged to render service to others as a normal activity, and not just at certain times of the year.
- T** for Teamwork. Operating the Patrol System will instil in our Scouts the necessity for teamwork, and this will undoubtedly help them in later years.
- E** for Experience. We all benefit from experience and this is especially the case for our Patrol Leaders and Assistant Patrol Leaders as they grow older, taking increased responsibility.
- M** for Mainstay. The mainstay I have been stressing throughout is the Patrol System. It is the only way to run a Scout Troop. It can be difficult times, it can bring disappointments, but if we persevere and support our Patrol Leaders it can also bring great satisfaction when, as Leaders, we can observe how our Scouts benefit and develop in a way that no other method or system can emulate.

I hope these thoughts have been of interest and assistance. If you would like to consider this fundamental subject in more detail I would recommend as appropriate reading the "Scouting" magazine reprint entitled "The Patrol System".

JIM ELLIOT

Cub Scouts

The sun has now been shining for two days and as I write this contribution I have the feeling that Spring has finally arrived. It never ceases to amaze me that a few days of sunshine, at this time of year, not only puts a brighter face on the countryside with the tree blossom and spring flowers, but it seems to take away the dreariness of Winter and fills one with new life ready for the coming summer months. Spring and Summer is the time for our programmes to be based on the outdoors! This is the time to take the Pack to the local park for games, tracking, etc; to plan expeditions, outings and camps where the Cub Scouts may take part in many of the activities for their arrows. If we do not plan for these outdoor activities now, it means that the Pack will not have the opportunity to light fires, cook a simple meal, follow a compass route, for example.

Whilst talking about the arrow scheme, I am told

that a revised Cub Scout Handbook will be available soon - hopefully during May.

On a lighter note, a Cub Scout from one of our local Packs called for a Job! Whilst filling in his Job Card, I noticed one entry made by one of our senior neighbours, it read: "For being so jolly - 10p". A job well done, don't you think?

Cub Meet 80

By the time you read this I hope you have already sent me your final booking form. If you haven't, please do it now. There may be a delay in sending out the badges, etc., as we have a slight problem with programmes, however, I hope to get all parcels despatched by the end of May. The badges are to be worn above the World Scout Badge, between 6th June and 6th August, 1980.

STEVE HALL

Congratulations

BAR TO THE MEDAL OF MERIT

H.T. Hall

G.S.L., 1st Chertsey

CHIEF SCOUT'S COMMENDATION FOR GOOD SERVICES

Mrs. R. Hall

Group Committee Member,
1st Chertsey

J.A. Sloane

Group Supporter,
3rd Sheerwater

LONG SERVICE DECORATION

B.C. Wood

A.C.C. (V.S.) Surrey

DUKE OF EDINBURGH'S GOLD AWARD

John Dodwell

Instructor, Chaldon

Paul Harriss

Instructor, 1st Whyteleafe

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Peter Andrews

1st Molesey

Peter Earle

1st Weston Green

Nuharren Hassan

Hatchford Park

Andrew Hubbard

3rd Sheerwater

Kevin Lardner

12th Caterham

Philip Lauder

Holy Trinity, Guildford

Andrew Miller

3rd Banstead

Richard Walker

2nd Epsom

County Chaplain

It's not normal to ask for invitations, but that's just what I'm going to do!

Some weeks ago, Barry Anderson, Keith Huxley and I were invited by the District Commissioners of the Runnymede, Staines and Sunbury and Shepperton Districts to meet their G.S.L.s and a number of local clergy to talk about spiritual development in Scouting.

To say that the evening was a success would be an understatement. About forty people accepted the D.C.s' invitation. For the benefit of the clergy - many of whom were strangers to the Movement - we talked about modern Scouting and the religious policy. There was plenty of time for questions, discussion groups highlighted some of the issues involved in our spiritual responsibilities and, at the end of the two

hour session Keith talked about resources available to help with this important but far from easy side of our work - and some of what he had to say was new even to well-seasoned leaders.

Naturally, not everyone went home happy and satisfied but we had intended to stimulate and provoke! And we were challenged where experienced leaders disagreed with us!

We're willing to mount similar sessions in other Districts. But we need your invitations before we can do so. We'll try to fit in with the times you suggest and make sure that the theme is tailored to local needs. We're glad that Barry now has wider responsibilities but Keith or I will be glad to hear from you with the suggestion of a venue and date.

MICHAEL MEECH

International

You will have read in the County Commissioner's notes that after 15 years as your "International Man" I felt it was time for a change and was delighted that Terry Maggs consented to step into the job. He comes to you with a wealth of experience in things international and I am confident that you will find his help and advice of the utmost value.

It has been a real pleasure and a privilege to work

amongst you. I shall remember the many events shared and enjoy the lasting friendships made. May you too find the same pleasure in your International Scouting.

Those who have still to return their Form P.C. (Abroad) and the two postcards should send them without delay to Terry R. Maggs, 39, Merland Rise, Epsom Downs, Surrey. Tel: Burgh Heath 54245.

JOHN HAVERS

1980 Census

Sincere congratulations are due to District Secretaries, District Treasurers and to all the Groups which made it possible. Never before have we had completed Census Returns from 50% of the County by 12th April. Well Done! And Treasurers too have really been doing their stuff - more than £14,000 has been received and sent on to Headquarters by this same date - that is more than 25% of the whole amount due to come in.

There was a rush to get Census Returns in first - Esher, Horley and Sunbury & Shepperton came all at the same time. Esher did extraordinarily well with

15 Groups to deal with whilst Horley and Sunbury & Shepperton actually managed to enclose the total subscriptions due, with the Census form!

Walton & Weybridge, Staines, Banstead, Epsom, Guildford, Godalming and Leatherhead all followed in quick succession.

Subscriptions too, have been coming in very well indeed. Other than the two Districts mentioned above, money has been received from Walton & Weybridge, Staines, Farnham, Banstead and Surrey Heath. Details of the Census, Districts permitting, will be published in the next issue of "Surrey Scout".

DOUG. BENNETT

Bentley Copse

By the time you read this, work should have started on improving the training facilities at Bentley Copse. A completely new ablution block is being built to incorporate flush toilets, showers and washing facilities. The kitchen of the training building is being extended and the Eric Walden Memorial Fund is for re-equipping this new kitchen. That Fund at present stands at £1,450. It would be a most fitting memorial to Eric if the Fund could completely pay for the

fittings of this new kitchen. As Eric was C.C. of G.L.S.W. it is right that most of the contributors to this Fund are from G.L.S.W., but there are many Scouters in Surrey who have cause to be grateful for his leadership on various courses. It is not too late to contribute to the Fund - to A.C. Allan, Esq., 2 Pitfield Drive, Meopham Green, Kent, DA13 0AY or to the County Treasurer who will gladly pass contributions on.

DOUG. BENNETT

Leader Training Courses

Scout Fellowship

Leatherhead 16th November, 1980

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 27th/28th September

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse October, 1980
(1 weekend to be confirmed)

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 16th/18th and 23rd/25th May

SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 7th/8th, 21st/22nd June and 5th/6th July

G.S.L./COMMISSIONERS

Bentley Copse 4th/5th October plus 22nd/23rd November

Water Activities Supervisory Skills Course

17th/18th May

Surrey Scout Leaders Activity Weekend

Bentley Copse 13th/14th September

E.J. Mackie, 30 Morton Road, East Grinstead.

J. Gibbons, 115 Hermitage Woods Crescent, St. Johns Woking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.

Information from J. Forbat, 46 Firlands, Ellesmere Road, Weybridge.

J.M. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne, Sussex.

County Directory

County

A.C.C. (International). Delete J. Havers.
Insert: T.R. Maggs, 39 Merland Rise, Epsom
Downs. Tel: Burgh Heath 54245

Woking

D.C. A.M. Allenby. Address now "Vistas", One
Tree Hill Road, Guildford. Tel: 75709.

County Diary

May

- 11 County Regatta
17-18 Water Activities Leadership
Supervisory Skills Course

June

- 5 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking
7 Chief Scout Award
Presentation Walton & Weybridge
9 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
10 Water Activities Sub-Committee Tadworth
13 County A.G.M. Farnham
27/28 Aquameet Longridge
/29

July

- 5-6 Cubmeet 80 Various
7 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
12-13 District Administrator's Workshop Guildford
13 Venture Scout First
Aid Competition
14 Programme & Training
Sub-Committee Dorking
16 Executive Committee London
18-20 Venture Scout Camp
29 Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee Ewell

September

- 8 Water Activities Sub-
Committee Walton-o-T
13-14 Scouting for Scout Leaders Bentley Copse
14 Sailing Regatta
18 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking
19-21 National Scouters Conference York
27-28 County Patrol & Camping
Competition Walton Firs

October

- 6 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
11 Chief Scout Award
Presentation Banstead
12 Surrey Venture Scout Rifle
Club Annual Shoot Bisley
13 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
14 Programme & Training
Sub-Committee Bookham
15 Executive Committee London
20 County Chaplain's Meeting Dorking
26 Venture Scout Cooking
Competition
28 Scout Fellowship Sub-
Committee Ewell

November

- 1 Swimming Gala Guildford
9 District Commissioner's
Symposium

15-16 Venture Competition

December

- 2 Water Activities Sub-Committee Staines
4 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking

June "Surrey Scout"

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